

HOW THE SUN'S PLANETS FORMED

Dust specks orbiting the young Sun stuck together to form pebbles. These gathered into worlds the size of our Moon (called "planetesimals"), which then collided to build up the rocky planets, such as Earth. Further out, Jupiter and Saturn scooped up gas, and grew into two of the four gas giants.



Most planetary systems are **small enough to fit inside Earth's orbit** around the Sun.

The star's planets orbit it so closely that they are too hot for life to exist there

Formed over 11 billion years ago, the Kepler-444 system is home to five planets smaller than Earth. The planets in this compact system orbit their Sun-like star in less than ten days.

What is space?